

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 2559

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

*Marcus S. Vaughn*

*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to protect a patient's right to a support person at health care facilities.

PETITION OF:

| NAME:                   | DISTRICT/ADDRESS:  | DATE ADDED:      |
|-------------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| <i>Marcus S. Vaughn</i> | <i>9th Norfolk</i> | <i>1/16/2025</i> |
| <i>Sue Chester</i>      |                    | <i>1/16/2025</i> |

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 2559

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By Representative Vaughn of Wrentham, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2559) of Marcus S. Vaughn and Sue Chester relative to patients' rights to a support person at health care facilities. Public Health.

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

\_\_\_\_\_  
In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court  
(2025-2026)  
\_\_\_\_\_

An Act to protect a patient's right to a support person at health care facilities.

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:*

1           Section 70E of chapter 111 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official  
2 Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after subsection (o) the following subsection:-

3           (p) to a person of their choosing to serve as a support person. The support person may be  
4 present with the patient 24 hours a day in patient-accessible areas of the health care facility or  
5 provider's office to accompany the patient while the patient is receiving inpatient or outpatient  
6 treatment or is consulting with their health care provider. A health care facility may temporarily  
7 restrict the presence of the support person during surgeries or emergency interventions. Health  
8 care facilities shall not require the support person to receive any vaccination as a condition for  
9 access to the patient.